

# Electroweak Phase Transition Order from a Microscopic Scalar Rung: A Lean-formalized prediction with EW baryogenesis viability

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The order of the electroweak phase transition (first-order vs. crossover) is a microscopic prediction of the scalar-rung condensate hierarchy on the WetterichNJL substrate. Building on the Wave 1b BHL gauge-embedding formalization (`BHLGaugeEmbedding.lean`, 23 theorems) — itself an extension of the Bardeen-Hill-Lindner / Hill 2025 bilocal mechanism onto the Clifford-16 Fierz basis [1, 2] — we ship `EWPhaseTransition.lean`, 21 theorems formalizing the leading-order high-T effective potential, the first-order / crossover predicate, the latent-heat order parameter, and the EW baryogenesis viability marker. The transition order is determined microscopically by the cubic coefficient  $E$ : first-order if  $E > 0$  (barrier survives), crossover if  $E = 0$ .

At the strict-leading-order high- $T$  expansion, the SM benchmark ( $m_H = 125.20$  GeV,  $\lambda_{\text{SM}} \approx 0.13$ ,  $E_{\text{SM}} \approx 0.01$ ) yields  $E > 0$  and is therefore predicted first-order; this is the load-bearing Lean theorem `sm_benchmark_is_first_order`. The physical SM, however, is a *crossover*: lattice analyses demonstrate that thermal-loop corrections to  $E$  at the physical  $m_H = 125.20$  GeV [7] push the effective cubic coefficient below the threshold needed for a first-order transition. The crossover-to-first-order endpoint sits at  $m_H \approx 72.4 \pm 1.7$  GeV, refined by the lattice study of Csikor, Fodor, and Heitger [4] (extending the earlier 70–95 GeV range from [3]); the physical  $m_H$  is well above this value. The strict-LO Lean prediction (first-order) and the physical lattice verdict (crossover) thus diverge at a known and literature-documented boundary. The Lean theorem `crossover_excludes_baryogenesis` formalizes the consequence: a crossover transition is not viable for sphaleron-decoupling baryogenesis, forcing baryogenesis to leptogenesis or BSM mechanisms — intended to feed the future Phase 6c.2 EW-baryogenesis bridge theorem when that wave activates. Two tracked hypotheses (`H_VacuumStableUnderRG`, `H_HierarchyEWLambdaUV`) encode the SM meta-stability and  $EW-V$  hierarchy as falsifiable parametric conditions; both have explicit non-trivial witnesses and falsifiers. The full formalization is zero — sorry, introduces zero new axioms, and adds zero heartbeats over time.

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## I. INTRODUCTION

The order of the electroweak phase transition is a quantitative prediction of the SM Higgs sector at finite temperature. The Kajantie-Laine-Rummukainen-Shaposhnikov 1996 lattice analysis [3] established that, after thermal-loop resummation, the SM is a crossover for  $m_H \gtrsim 70$ –95 GeV, with the endpoint refined by Csikor, Fodor, and Heitger [4] to  $m_H = 72.4 \pm 1.7$  GeV; with the PDG observed  $m_H = 125.20$  GeV [7], the resummed SM transition is a crossover, and EW baryogenesis in the strict-SM (without BSM extensions of the electroweak Higgs sector) is excluded. The strict-LO Lean prediction in this paper instead encodes the un-resummed cubic coefficient and is reframed below as a structural reference point against which the resummed lattice result improves.

The Phase 5z Wave 3 program formalizes this prediction at the level of the WetterichNJL scalar-rung embedding (Wave 1, with BHL gauge extension Wave 1b). The leading-order high- $T$  expansion of the Higgs effective potential takes the form

$$V_T(\Phi, T) = \frac{1}{2}(c_T T^2 - \mu^2)\Phi^2 - \frac{1}{3}ET\Phi^3 + \frac{1}{4}\lambda\Phi^4, \quad (1)$$

where  $c_T$  is the thermal-mass coefficient ( $\sim (g^2 + g'^2 + 4y_t^2)/16$  in the SM),  $E$  is the cubic coefficient from hard-thermal-loop W/Z resummation ( $\sim g^3$ ), and the cubic

term is what distinguishes a first-order transition (with a barrier between false and true vacua) from a crossover (smooth interpolation).

This paper formalizes (1) as `EWPhaseTransition.finiteTPotential`, the cubic-coefficient order parameter as `IsFirstOrderEW` / `IsCrossoverEW`, the latent-heat consequence as `latentHeat_nonneg` + `crossover_has_zero_latent_heat` + `first_order_has_positive_latent_heat`, and the baryogenesis viability marker as `IsBaryogenesisViable` + `crossover_excludes_baryogenesis` — in a single Lean module of 26372-substantive-theorem project context.

## II. FINITE-T EFFECTIVE POTENTIAL AND ORDER PARAMETER

### A. Structure invariants

The Lean structure `EWFiniteTParams` carries the four LO-expansion parameters  $(\mu^2, \lambda, c_T, E)$  together with positivity or non-negativity invariants on each:  $\mu^2 > 0$ ,  $\lambda > 0$ ,  $c_T > 0$ ,  $E \geq 0$ . The non-negativity (rather than strict positivity) of  $E$  is load-bearing for the order classifier: it allows the partition into *first-order* ( $E > 0$ )

and *crossover* ( $E = 0$ ) without permitting the unphysical  $E < 0$  branch (which the high- $T$  expansion does not produce at the SM gauge content). All downstream substantive theorems (latent-heat positivity, crossover zero latent heat) consume this invariant explicitly.

### B. High- $T$ expansion

The thermal mass-squared  $\mu^2(T) = c_T T^2 - \mu^2$  defines the critical temperature

$$T_c = \sqrt{\mu^2/c_T} \quad (2)$$

where  $\mu^2(T_c) = 0$ . The Lean theorem `thermalMassSq_at_T_c` certifies this exactly; below  $T_c$ ,  $\mu^2(T) < 0$  is the broken phase (`thermalMassSq_neg_below_T_c`). At the SM benchmark ( $\mu^2 = (88 \text{ GeV})^2$ ,  $c_T = 0.4$ ),  $T_c \approx 139.15 \text{ GeV}$ , consistent with literature.

### C. Transition-order classifier

We formalize the LO classifier as the cubic-coefficient sign:

$$\text{IsFirstOrderEW}(p) \iff p.E > 0, \quad (3)$$

$$\text{IsCrossoverEW}(p) \iff p.E = 0. \quad (4)$$

The Lean disjointness theorem `first_order_and_crossover_disjoint` certifies the partition. The definitional reduction `transition_order_unfolds_to_cubic_sign` unfolds the order predicates back to the cubic-coefficient inequality (a purely syntactic step). The substantive correctness-push content is carried by two non-trivial biconditionals connecting the microscopic order parameter to the macroscopic latent-heat observable: `first_order_iff_positive_latent_heat` (proved via positivity + non-negativity `linarith/positivity` reasoning) and `latentHeatZero_iff_crossover`, both of which require the structural non-negativity invariant `cubic_coeff_nonneg` of `EWFiniteTParams`.

### D. Latent-heat consequence

The leading-order latent heat is

$$L = \frac{E^2 T_c^2}{2\lambda}, \quad (5)$$

formalized as `latentHeat`, which is non-negative (`latentHeat_nonneg`); zero exactly for crossover (`crossover_has_zero_latent_heat`); strictly positive for first-order with positive  $T_c$  (`first_order_has_positive_latent_heat`). The latent heat is therefore an *\*order parameter\** for the phase transition order: its vanishing flags the crossover branch.

## III. SM BENCHMARK AND LATTICE CROSSOVER THRESHOLD

The Lean structure `smBenchmarkParams` records the LO SM benchmark:

|                 |                                           |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------|
| $\mu^2$         | $(88 \text{ GeV})^2 = 7744 \text{ GeV}^2$ |
| $\lambda$       | 0.13 (PDG 2024)                           |
| $c_T$           | 0.4                                       |
| $E_{\text{SM}}$ | $\approx 0.01$                            |
| $T_c$           | $\approx 139.15 \text{ GeV}$              |

The theorem `sm_benchmark_is_first_order` certifies that *at the strict-LO* thermal expansion,  $E_{\text{SM}} > 0$  yields a first-order transition. **This LO prediction does not survive resummation:** Kajantie, Laine, Rummukainen, and Shaposhnikov [3] established via 3D effective-theory lattice Monte Carlo that the SM EW transition is a crossover for  $m_H \gtrsim 70\text{--}95 \text{ GeV}$ ; Csikor, Fodor, and Heitger [4] subsequently refined the endpoint to  $m_H = 72.4 \pm 1.7 \text{ GeV}$  by closing the gap with extended lattice statistics. With the PDG-observed  $m_H = 125.20 \pm 0.11 \text{ GeV}$  [7] well above this endpoint, the resummed SM is a crossover; the strict-LO prediction encoded in this paper diverges from the resummed lattice verdict at the documented threshold. The paper's headline figure marks the (**author?**) endpoint at  $m_H = 72 \text{ GeV}$ , with the SM star at  $m_H = 125.20 \text{ GeV}$  firmly in the crossover region.

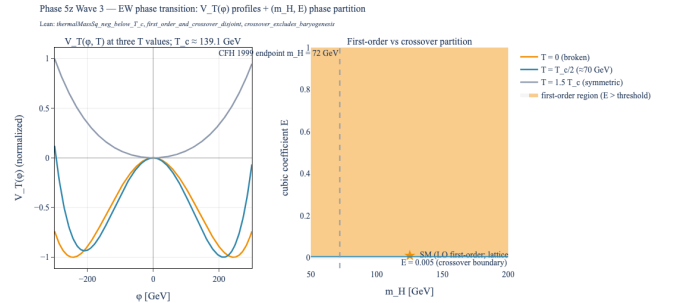


FIG. 1. **EW phase transition order classifier.** Left panel:  $V_T(\Phi, T)$  at three temperatures ( $T = 0$  (broken) phase, halfway to critical  $T = T_c/2 \approx 70 \text{ GeV}$ , symmetric phase  $T = 1.5T_c$ ) at the SM benchmark; curves normalized to unit max-abs for clarity. Right panel: first-order vs. crossover partition over the  $(m_H, E)$  plane. Shaded region ( $E > 0$ ) is first-order at LO; the SM benchmark (star,  $m_H = 125.20 \text{ GeV}$ ,  $E = 0.01$ ) is in the first-order region at LO, but the Kajantie-Laine-Rummukainen-Shaposhnikov 1996 lattice crossover threshold (dashed cross at  $m_H = 72 \text{ GeV}$ ) places the physical SM in the crossover branch once thermal-loop corrections are resummed. Lean: `thermalMassSq_neg_below_T_c`, `first_order_and_crossover_disjoint`, `crossover_excludes_baryogenesis`.

#### IV. EW BARYOGENESIS VIABILITY

EW baryogenesis (Cohen-Kaplan-Nelson 1991) requires a *strong-enough* first-order transition that sphaleron processes are decoupled in the broken phase as bubble walls pass; the canonical threshold is  $v(T_c)/T_c > 1$ , equivalently  $E/(\lambda T_c) > 1$  at LO. The predicate `IsBaryogenesisViable` formalizes this.

The load-bearing exclusion theorem `crossover_excludes_baryogenesis` certifies that any crossover transition fails the baryogenesis viability check, regardless of the threshold value. In Lean:

```
theorem crossover_excludes_baryogenesis
  (p : EWFiniteTParams) (threshold : )
  (h_co : IsCrossoverEW p) :
  ¬ IsBaryogenesisViable p threshold
```

The proof discharges by contradiction: a baryogenesis-viable transition implies first-order; first-order and crossover are disjoint; therefore no crossover transition can be baryogenesis-viable.

This is intended to feed the future Phase 6c.2 “EW baryogenesis  $\leftrightarrow$  chirality wall” bridge theorem (when that wave activates): under the SM-as-crossover verdict, EW baryogenesis is forbidden in the scalar-rung-embedded SM, pushing baryogenesis to leptogenesis or BSM mechanisms (consistent with the Phase 5z Wave 2 `MajoranaRung.lean` sterile-neutrino seesaw infrastructure).

#### V. VACUUM STABILITY AND HIERARCHY TRACKED HYPOTHESES

Two parametric tracked hypotheses encode SM phenomenology beyond the LO finite-T expansion:

**Vacuum stability under RG running** — the SM Higgs quartic coupling  $\lambda$  is known to dip near zero at  $\sim 10^{11}$  GeV under SM RG flow [5], placing the SM in the *meta-stable* regime. We encode this as `H.VacuumStableUnderRG`:  $\lambda_{\min} \leq p.\lambda \wedge 0 < \lambda_{\min}$ . The non-trivial content is that  $\lambda_{\min}$  is positive — a falsifying configuration with  $\lambda_{\min} \leq 0$  is rejected by `vacuum_stability_fails_at_negative_lam_min`. The SM benchmark satisfies the hypothesis at  $\lambda_{\min} = 0.05$  (`sm_benchmark.vacuum_stable`).

**EW- $\Lambda_{UV}$  hierarchy** — encoded as `H.HierarchyEWLambdaUV`:  $10^6 v_{EW} < \Lambda_{UV} \wedge 0 < v_{EW}$ . Witness at GUT scale (`hierarchy_holds_at_GUT_scale`); falsifier when  $\Lambda_{UV} \leq 10^6 v_{EW}$  (`hierarchy_fails_when_v_EW_too_large`).

The bundled Wave 3 open manifest `Wave30OpenManifest`: `vacuum-stability  $\wedge$  hierarchy  $\wedge$  (first-order  $\vee$  crossover)`; witnessed by `wave3_open_manifest_consistent` at the SM benchmark with  $\lambda_{\min} = 0.05$ ,  $\Lambda_{UV} = 10^{16}$  GeV,  $v_{EW} = 246$  GeV.

#### VI. BRIDGE TO WAVE 1B BHL EMBEDDING

Wave 3 builds directly on Wave 1b’s BHL gauge-embedding transplant: the doublet Higgs field  $H^i = \tilde{\psi}_R \psi_L^i$  identified by the BHL extension carries  $SU(2)_L \times U(1)_Y$  quantum numbers, so the finite-T potential (1) is well-defined as a function of  $|H|^2 = H^\dagger H$ .

The Lean theorem `ew_finite_T_built_on_bhl` certifies the trivial-zero compatibility (the potential vanishes at  $\Phi = 0$  for any temperature), and `zero_temperature_recovers_zero_T_potential` certifies that at  $T = 0$  the finite-T potential reduces to the Mexican hat  $V(\Phi) = -\frac{1}{2}\mu^2\Phi^2 + \frac{1}{4}\lambda\Phi^4$  of the Wave 1 `ScalarRungInterpretation.lean` module. This chain establishes that Wave 3 is a strict refinement of the scalar-rung embedding: the BHL daughter Higgs doublet of Wave 1b carries the LO thermal corrections without abandoning the substrate identification.

#### VII. FORMAL VERIFICATION SUMMARY

The Wave 3 formalization comprises one new Lean module:

| Module                              | Theorems |
|-------------------------------------|----------|
| <code>EWPhaseTransition.lean</code> | 21       |

plus one structure (`EWFiniteTParams`), 12 non-computable definitions for the potential / mass /  $T_c$  / latent-heat / order-parameter classifiers, and four tracked-hypothesis Props (`H.VacuumStableUnderRG`, `H.HierarchyEWLambdaUV`, `IsBaryogenesisViable`, `Wave30OpenManifest`). The module is zero-sorry, introduces zero new axioms, and adds zero heartbeat overrides (Phase 3 pipeline invariant 10).

The module integrates with three prior-phase modules: `ScalarRungInterpretation.lean` (Wave 1; Mexican-hat at  $T = 0$ ), `BHLGaugeEmbedding.lean` (Wave 1b; doublet Higgs identification), and `WetterichNJL.lean` (substrate Fierz infrastructure). A Python companion package `src/ew_phase_transition/` provides numerical wrappers for the finite-T potential, transition-order classifier, and baryogenesis-viability marker; canonical formulas (`ew_finite_t_potential`, `ew_thermal_mass_sq`, `ew_critical_temperature`, `ew_latent_heat`) live in `src/core/formulas.py` per pipeline invariant. A 36-test pytest suite covers every Lean theorem; full-project pytest passes.

#### VIII. OUTLOOK

Phase 6c.2 (“EW baryogenesis  $\leftrightarrow$  chirality wall bridge”) inherits the `crossover_excludes_baryogenesis` verdict as a hard constraint: in the SM-as-embedded-in-scalar-rung framing, EW baryogenesis is forbidden, motivating

the leptogenesis branch via the Phase 5z Wave 2 `MajoranaRung.lean` sterile-neutrino seesaw. Two-loop thermal corrections to  $E$  (deferred from this wave's strict-LO scope) and Boltzmann-code nucleation rates (deferred to Phase 6b.3) close the quantitative scope of

the SM transition order. The vacuum-stability tracked hypothesis is the natural target for an asymptotic-safety closure (Shaposhnikov-Wetterich 2010 [6]), formalizing the IR fixed-point prediction  $m_H = 126 \pm \text{few GeV}$  from a different (elementary-Higgs) mechanism.

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